

Lesson 1

您好 — Hello (Formal Greeting)

Let's Learn Mandarin · Book 1 · Teacher's Manual

壹. Learning Objectives

Theme: Greetings

After completing this lesson, students will be able to use Chinese to:
1. Greet others. 2. Introduce their own surname and nationality, and ask others the same.

貳. Key Teaching Points and Activity Design

I. Warm-Up Activity

1. **Activity method:** Using a scenario of meeting students for the first time, greet students with short dialogues. Flashcards and picture cards may be used.
 2. **Sentences to use:**
 - 你好。/ 我姓____，叫____。/ 我是____老師。/ 我是____人。
 - Hello. / My surname is _____, my given name is _____. / I am Teacher _____. / I am from _____.
 3. The sentences used may be written on the board in phonetic romanization (optional).
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II. Vocabulary Instruction

1. “您” (nín) is the formal/polite form of “你” (nǐ, “you”). It is generally used with someone you are meeting for the first time, or with an elder.
2. “貴姓” (guì xìng, “your honorable surname”) is a polite phrase used when meeting someone for the first time to ask their surname. You cannot use “貴姓” to introduce your own surname.
3. “請問” (qǐng wèn, “excuse me / may I ask”) is a polite expression used before asking someone a question. Students should be encouraged to habitually add “請問” before questions.
4. “字” (zì, “character”) alone is read in the fourth tone, but in the word “名字” (míng·zi, “name”) it becomes a neutral tone as part of a compound word — mark it as neutral tone.
5. “臺灣 / 台灣” — both forms are listed in this book, as both are acceptable. Teachers may choose which to use based on their needs.
6. The “Phrases” category in this book’s vocabulary list is an approach that emphasizes communicative function. Fixed structures and expressions can be used by students immediately, without being restricted by grammatical structure analysis. For example, “貴姓” (your honorable surname) is not broken down into the separate meanings of “貴” and “姓,” but is learned as a unit used to ask someone’s surname. There is no need to explain this

word from a character-by-character teaching perspective.

7. “您呢” (nín ne, “And you?”) — it is recommended to teach this as a whole vocabulary item in this lesson rather than explaining the individual meaning and function of “呢” separately. The particle “呢” will be addressed in the grammar section later in the book.
8. The exercises in this book may require adding **supplementary vocabulary**, which can also be used to extend vocabulary related to the lesson. For example, since this lesson teaches “你” (you) and “我” (I), supplementing “他” (he) gives the teacher more flexibility during exercises.

◎ Teaching Method

For zero-level vocabulary instruction, it is recommended to teach **from top to bottom, using sentences as the foundation** — not treating vocabulary in isolation from the text. During instruction, the context should be paired with the text and grammar, introducing vocabulary simultaneously, so students learn to recognize words and become familiar with their usage, and then consolidate pronunciation. See the Suggested Teaching Flow under Text Instruction for step-by-step details.

III. Grammar Instruction

1. 姓 / 叫 (Surname / Given Name)

(1) “姓” is a verb; it can only be followed by a surname.

- S + 姓 + surname
- 我姓王。 (*My surname is Wang.*)
- 我姓 Lee。 (*My surname is Lee.*)

(2) “叫” is a verb; it can be followed by a given name/first name or a full name. Other uses of “叫” are not extended in this lesson.

- S + 叫 + given name / first name or full name
- 我叫明文。 (*My name is Mingwen.*)
- 我叫王明文。 (*My name is Wang Mingwen.*)

(3) Using this sentence pattern to give a complete self-introduction of one's name:

- 我姓 + surname , 叫 given name / first name.
- 我姓 Lee , 叫 Gloria。 (*My surname is Lee; my given name is Gloria.*)
- 我姓王 , 叫明文。 (*My surname is Wang; my given name is Mingwen.*)

◎ **Common student errors:** 1. S + “姓” + given name — e.g., 我姓明文。 (*incorrect: “My surname is Mingwen.”*) 2. 我 + “叫” + surname — e.g., 我叫王。 (*incorrect: “I’m called Wang.”*)

2. 是 (To be)

“是” is a verb; it can be followed by a given name/first name, full name, or nationality. Other uses of “是” are not extended in this lesson.

- S + 是 + given name / first name, full name, nationality
- 我是明文。 (*I am Mingwen.*)
- 我是 Gloria Lee。 (*I am Gloria Lee.*)
- 我是 臺灣人。 (*I am Taiwanese.*)

◎ **Common student error:** S + “是” + surname — e.g., 我是王。
(*incorrect: “I am Wang.”*)

3. 什麼 (What)

“什麼” is an interrogative pronoun in Chinese. In question sentences that use interrogative pronouns, the word order is **exactly the same** as in declarative sentences. In this lesson, “什麼名字” is the question word used to ask someone’s name or full name.

- S + V + 什麼名字 (Question Pronoun)
- 您 叫 什麼名字 ? (*What is your name?*) — question
- 我 叫 王明文。 (*My name is Wang Mingwen.*) — statement
- ※ Word order in question and declarative sentences is the same.
- S + V + 什麼名字 / 什麼 (Question Pronoun)
- 他 叫 什麼名字 ? (*What is his name?*)
- 明文 姓 什麼 ? (*What is Mingwen’s surname?*)

◎ **Common student error:** Students use English (native language) word order to ask someone’s name — e.g., 什麼是你的名字 ? (*incorrect word order*)

IV. Text Instruction

◆ Key Sentences

1. 您好 ! (*Hello! [formal]*)
2. 您貴姓 ? (*May I ask your surname?*)
3. 您叫什麼名字 ? (*What is your name?*)
4. 您是哪國人 ? (*What country are you from?*)

◆ Suggested Teaching Flow

1. The teacher takes on the role of Wang Mingwen and Gloria Lee in turn (character portraits and national flag images may be used) to produce some of the lesson’s sentences. For example: “我姓王，叫明文。我是臺灣人。” (*My surname is Wang, my given name is Mingwen. I am Taiwanese.*) This exposes students to the lesson’s key sentences.
2. Lead the class in reading the text aloud; students repeat together. Prepare picture cards / word cards to help students understand the text.
3. **Introduce grammar:** Divide the dialogue into sections based on grammar points and teach each part in sequence. First help students understand the meaning and roughly memorize the pronunciation, then reinforce individual grammar structures and vocabulary. For example:

(1) Use the situational context to introduce the dialogue:

- A: 您貴姓 ? (*May I ask your surname?*)
- B: 我姓王。 (*My surname is Wang.*)
- A: 我姓 Lee，叫 Gloria。您叫什麼名字 ? (*My surname is Lee, my name is Gloria. What is your name?*)

(2) Teacher-student Q&A to help students get familiar with the sentences, memorize meaning, and pronounce accurately.

(3) Introduce Grammar Pattern 1 — 姓 / 叫 — and the vocabulary “貴姓.” Use question-and-answer substitution drills for students to confirm the grammar structure and pay attention to pronunciation.

(4) Introduce the next section of dialogue, leading into Grammar Patterns 2 and 3 and remaining vocabulary:

- A: 您叫什麼名字? (*What is your name?*)
- B: 我叫明文。請問您是哪國人? (*My name is Mingwen. May I ask, what country are you from?*)
- A: 我是美國人。您呢? (*I am American. And you?*)
- B: 我是臺灣人。 (*I am Taiwanese.*)

(5) Comprehensively review grammar structures, Chinese characters, and pronunciation with students.

4. After leading the class through the text again, ask comprehension questions based on the text.

Sample questions:

- 1. Gloria 姓什麼? (*What is Gloria's surname?*)
- 2. 她是哪國人? (*What country is she from?*)
- 3. 明文姓什麼? (*What is Mingwen's surname?*)
- 4. 他是哪國人? (*What country is he from?*)

Then ask students to answer based on their own situations:

- 5. 你姓什麼? (*What is your surname?*)
- 6. 你叫什麼名字? (*What is your name?*)
- 7. 你是哪國人? (*What country are you from?*)

5. Have students practice reading the text in groups, then have individual students take turns reading aloud; correct pronunciation as needed.

6. Use the content (facts) from the text to have students practice narration using what they have learned, in order to achieve the lesson's learning objectives. Students should be able to develop not only dialogue but also monologue-style narration.

(1) Have students work in pairs to use the lesson's key sentences to cooperatively introduce Wang Mingwen and Gloria.

(2) The teacher uses word cards or a PPT to provide the necessary vocabulary or phrases, and has students produce the following content:

- a. 明文姓王。 (*Mingwen's surname is Wang.*)
- b. 王明文是臺灣人。 (*Wang Mingwen is Taiwanese.*)
- c. Gloria 姓 Lee。 (*Gloria's surname is Lee.*)
- d. Gloria 是美國人。 (*Gloria is American.*)

(The above content may be adjusted flexibly by the teacher based on students' level and circumstances.)

7. After finishing text instruction, guide students through the grammar exercises to confirm grammar structures.

8. After completing the grammar exercises, explain or demonstrate the stroke order for Chinese characters that have complex structures or that students are likely to make mistakes on.

V. Integrated Activities

1. Integrated Activity 1 — Read Aloud / Sight-Read

(1) Objective: Students can recognize the Chinese characters and sentences in the dialogue without the aid of phonetic notation or romanization, and pronounce them correctly.

(2) Method: - a. Have students practice the dialogue in groups. - b. The teacher calls on students to take turns reading the dialogue aloud.

2. Integrated Activity 2 — Fill in the Blanks / Writing

(1) Objective: After repeating and memorizing the sentences learned in this lesson, students understand the dialogue content and can write the missing parts using Chinese characters or phonetic notation.

(2) Method: - a. Have students fill in the dialogue content. - b. The teacher calls on students to read aloud or write out the answers. - c. Writing characters or phonetic notation may be arranged based on students' level. - d. For students who learn quickly and are at a higher level, the supplementary activity may replace the original activity if time allows. The procedure is the same.

Supplementary Activity (*Students add or reduce sentences based on their own situation*)

A: 您好! (Hello!) B: _____! A: 我姓_____, 請問_____貴姓? (My surname is _____. May I ask your surname?) B: 我姓_____, 叫_____. 請問_____叫什麼_____? (My surname is _____, my name is _____. May I ask what _____ your name _____?) A: 我叫_____. 請問您_____哪國人? (My name is _____. May I ask what country you are from?) B: 我是_____人。_____呢? (I am from _____. And you?) A: 我是_____人。 (I am from _____.)

3. Integrated Activity 3 — Speaking

(1) Objective: Students can fluently use the sentences learned in this lesson to introduce and ask about themselves and others' names and nationalities.

(2) Method: - a. Explain the activity procedure and remind students of the sentences they need to use. - b. After students complete their interviews, have them fill out a form and introduce the student they interviewed to the whole class. - c. Depending on the situation, pair students up and have them complete the dialogue in front of the whole class. The dialogue content can refer to the Supplementary Activity from Integrated Activity 2.

4. Integrated Activity 4 — Reading

(1) Objective: Using authentic materials, train students to recognize Chinese surnames and distinguish between surname and given name.

(2) Method: - a. Explain the activity procedure. - b. Have students find people's names on business cards. - c. After students finish, the teacher calls on students to respond. - d. The teacher may ask students additional oral questions about the business card content.

VI. Supplementary Text Instruction

As circumstances allow, the teacher may use the following material as a supplementary reading or listening exercise. The teacher may read the dialogue aloud to train students' listening, or make it into a handout for reading practice.

Please answer the questions below based on the dialogue:

A: 您好。(Hello.) B: 您好。(Hello.) A: 我姓王, 請問您貴姓?(My surname is Wang. May I ask your surname?) B: 我姓 Lee, 叫 Steve。您叫什麼名字?(My surname is Lee, my name is Steve. What is your name?) A: 我叫明美。我是臺灣人。您呢?(My name is Mingmei. I am Taiwanese. And you?) B: 我是美國人。(I am American.)

Questions: 1. 明美姓什麼?(What is Mingmei's surname?) 2. Steve 姓什麼?(What is Steve's surname?) 3. Steve 是哪國人?(What country is Steve from?) 4. 明美是哪國人?(What country is Mingmei from?)

Answer Key: 1. 明美姓王。(Mingmei's surname is Wang.) 2. Steve 姓 Lee。(Steve's surname is Lee.) 3. Steve 是美國人。(Steve is American.) 4. 明美是臺灣人。(Mingmei is Taiwanese.)

VII. Phonetics Instruction / Phonetics Review

This textbook includes a phonetics system placed after each lesson. If students have not yet studied Chinese phonetic symbols, the teacher may teach these symbols section by section. If students have already studied phonetic symbols, review the pronunciation and spelling rules again.

1. Introduce Chinese syllables.

- 1. Using this lesson's vocabulary as examples: one Chinese character equals one syllable; each syllable consists of an initial consonant, a final, and a tone — though some syllables have no initial consonant.
- 2. Demonstrate how to write tone marks; tone marks are placed above the final vowel. Neutral tone syllables are not marked with a tone mark.

2. This lesson introduces the following phonetics:

- Initials: b、p、m、f
 - Finals: a、o、e、-i、-u、-ü
3. For phonetic combinations that do not exist in this lesson, try to find examples from vocabulary in other lessons for practice, using as few non-existent Mandarin sound combinations as possible. To practice all four tones of a syllable, some non-existent syllables may appear; the book marks these with parentheses — e.g., (mū) — to indicate this syllable does not exist as a pronunciation in Mandarin.
4. Use slides or word cards to have students read sentences or words aloud, correcting pronunciation as needed.

◎ Teaching Note

Teachers may flexibly adjust instruction based on individual students' situations or the teaching environment. If students are reluctant to learn Chinese characters, instruction may first focus on listening, speaking, and reading, delaying Chinese character writing. Use Hanyu Pinyin first for pronunciation and sentence pattern practice to cultivate students' listening, speaking, and character recognition

abilities. Let students encounter Chinese characters without pressure, and delay introducing character writing until a later lesson as circumstances allow.

參. Answer Key for In-Book Exercises

◆ Grammar Exercise Answers

1. 姓 / 叫 - (1) 21 (2) 321 (3) 213 (4) 31254

2. 是 - (1) 213 (2) 312 (3) 2413 (4) 2134

3. 什麼 - (1) 3142 (2) 2143 (3) 213 (4) 231

◆ Integrated Activity Answers

1. **Read Aloud** — (omitted)

2. **Fill in the Blanks**

您好 / 姓 / 您 / Lee / Gloria / 您 / 名字 / 叫 / 是 / 美國 / 您 / 是

(Hello / surname / you [formal] / Lee / Gloria / you [formal] / name / called / is / American / you [formal] / is)

3. **Speaking** — (omitted)

4. **Reading** — (see business card images in original)

◆ Phonetics Exercise Answers

1. **Tone Discrimination** - (1) (omitted) - (2) bà (爸 father) / mǔ (母 mother) / fà (髮 hair) / bù (部 section) / pó (婆 grandmother) / fā (發 to send) / mǎ (馬 horse) - (3) bā (八 eight) / mù (木 wood) / fǎ (乏 lacking) / bǔ (補 supplement) / mā (媽 mom) / pò (破 broken) / tú (圖 picture)

2. **Word Discrimination** - (1) bá (拔) / pǔ (普) / bǔ (補) / pó (婆) / fā (發) / mù (木) / mà (罵) - (2) bō (波) / fó (佛) / mǎ (馬) / má (麻) / pà (怕) / fǔ (府) / mò (莫)

肆. Workbook Answer Key

I. Text Comprehension

1. ✕ 2. ○ 3. ✕ 4. ○

II. Tone Discrimination

1. wǒ / hǎo / nín / jiào / qǐng
2. shì / hǎo / jiào / rén / měi

III. Word Discrimination

1. 1. 姓 (2) 人 (3) 好 (4) 請 (5) 叫
2. 1. 您好 (2) 名字 (3) 請問 (4) 您貴姓 (5) 臺灣人
3. 叫 / 是 / 貴姓 / 名字 / 什麼

IV. Sentence Restructuring

1. bac 2. acb 3. badc 4. badc 5. caebd

V. Matching

1. b 2. d 3. a 4. c

VI. Translation

1. 您好! (*Hello! [formal]*)
 2. 我姓王。(*My surname is Wang.*)
 3. 請問您貴姓? (*May I ask your surname?*)
 4. 我姓李, 我叫 Gloria。(*My surname is Li; my name is Gloria.*)
 5. 我是美國人。您呢? (*I am American. And you?*)
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伍. Test Answer Key

I. Listening

1. qǐng wèn (請問) 2. guì xìng (貴姓) 3. nín ne (您呢)
4. shénme (什麼) 5. nǎ guó rén (哪國人)

II. Restructuring

1. cba 2. bac 3. cab 4. bcda 5. cbda

III. Matching

1. b 2. d 3. a 4. c

IV. Dictation

1. 請問 2. 貴姓 3. 您呢 4. 什麼 5. 哪國人
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陸. Supplementary Online Resources

1. Ministry of Education Standard Script Stroke Order Learning Website

<http://stroke-order.learningweb.moe.edu.tw/home.do>

(1) Stroke Order: Characters in this lesson such as “您、麼、哪、國” are prone to stroke order errors among students beginning to learn Chinese characters. The teacher may demonstrate the stroke order in class.

(2) Structure: Write the following characters on the board (or project them) and have students discuss together to find other characters with similar structures. This activity may be expanded based on students' level and available time. The teacher should minimize explanation and let students discuss on their own, finding answers visually. The goal is for students to develop a general sense of left-right structured characters; keep the process engaging.

Which of the following characters can fit into the structures below? 好 我 貴 姓 王 是 請 國 明 人 他

Example structures: 姓□ □□ □□ □□

Answer: 姓、請、明、他

2. Chinese Character Story Short Videos

Suitable for beginners. No audio narration — includes character evolution, stroke order, and pronunciation.

- 1. 「人」 (person): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9BzL9OR-BtQ>
 - 2. 「我」 (I/me): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wKD5__0fhkI
 - 3. 「王」 (king/surname Wang): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yeupJ22kvXU>
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3. 你好歌 — “Hello Song” (Little Fox)

The video subtitles are in Traditional Chinese characters. The sentences are simple and the melody is light and lively. The teacher may play it on the first day of this lesson or at the end of the lesson for the class to sing along.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m_rDIzj6DRE